



Classification:  $K$  nearest neighbor

COMP7404

Computational Intelligence and Machine Learning

Dong Xu

# Outline

- Face recognition: applications, challenges and systems
- $k$  Nearest Neighbor classifier for face recognition

# Application of Face Recognition in Video Surveillance



■ Recording

**Report**



**Detecting....**

**Matching with Database**



Name: Alireza,  
Date: 25 My 2007 15:45  
Place: Main corridor



Name: **Unknown**  
Date: 25 My 2007 15:45  
Place: Main corridor

# Labeled Faces in the Wild (2007)



Random guess  
(50%)

Best results  
without deep learning

MSRA TL Joint Bayesian (96.33%)

Human funneled (99.20%)  
**CUHK deep learning result (99.53%)**  
**Google deep learning result (99.6%)**



# Applications of Face Recognition for Automatic Photo Organization

- Album organization: iPhoto 2009



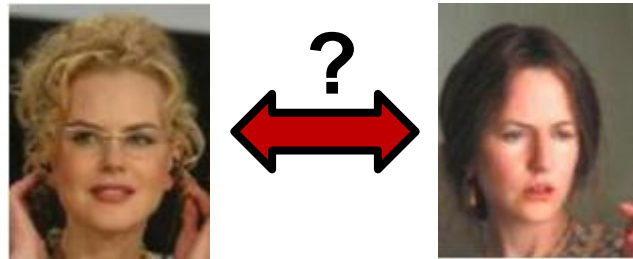
<http://www.apple.com/ilife/iphoto/>

# Face Recognition Systems

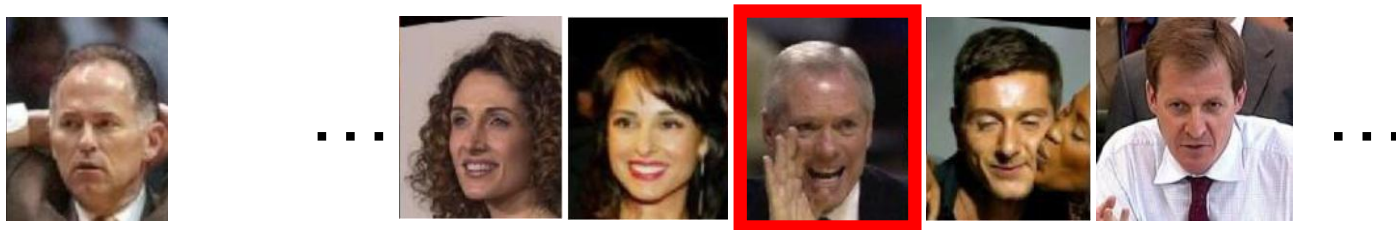
- Face detection
- Face alignment
- Face recognition

# Typical face recognition scenarios

- Verification: a person is claiming a particular identity; verify whether that is true



- Closed-world identification: assign a face to one person from among a known set



- General identification: assign a face to a known person or to “unknown”

# What makes face recognition hard?

- Expression
- Lighting
- Occlusion
- Viewpoint

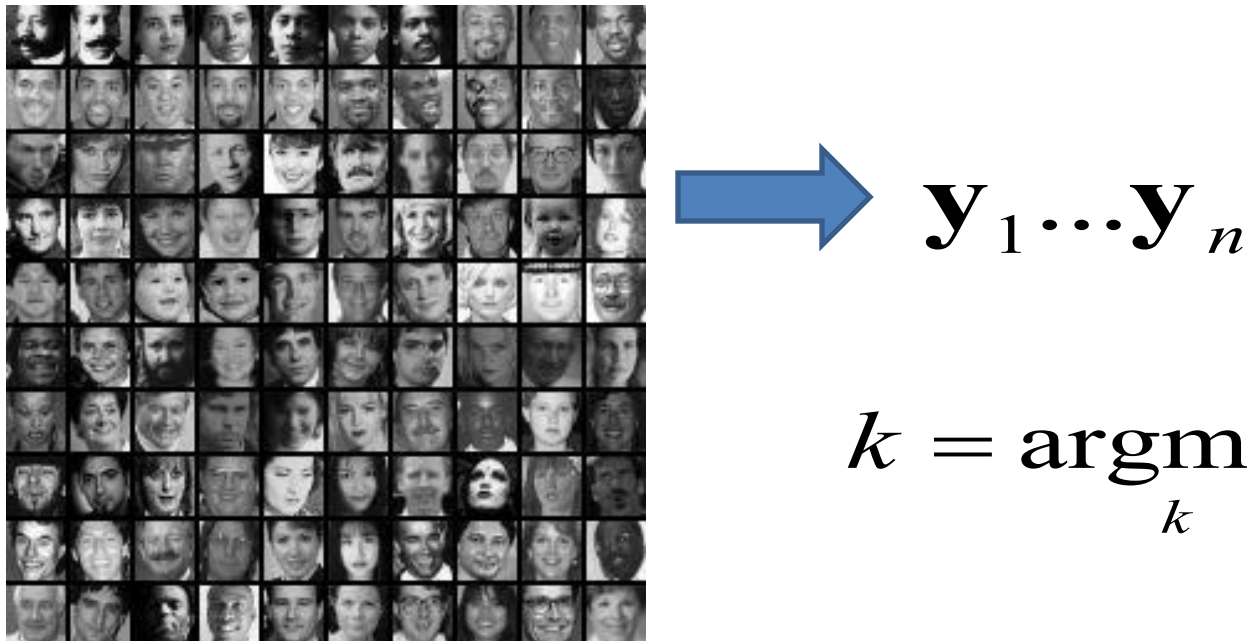


# Simple idea for face recognition

1. Treat face image as a vector of intensities



2. Recognize face by nearest neighbor in database



$$k = \operatorname{argmin}_k \|\mathbf{y}_k - \mathbf{x}\|$$

# Classification: $k$ Nearest Neighbor

- The  $K$  Nearest Neighbor ( $kNN$ ) is a very intuitive method that classifies unlabeled examples based on their similarity to examples in the training set

For a given unlabeled example  $x_u \in R^d$ , find the  $k$  “closest” labeled examples in the training data set and assign  $x_u$  to the class that appears most frequently within the  $k$ -subset.

- The  $kNN$  only requires
  - 1) An integer  $k$
  - 2) A set of labeled examples (training data)
  - 3) A metric to measure “closeness”

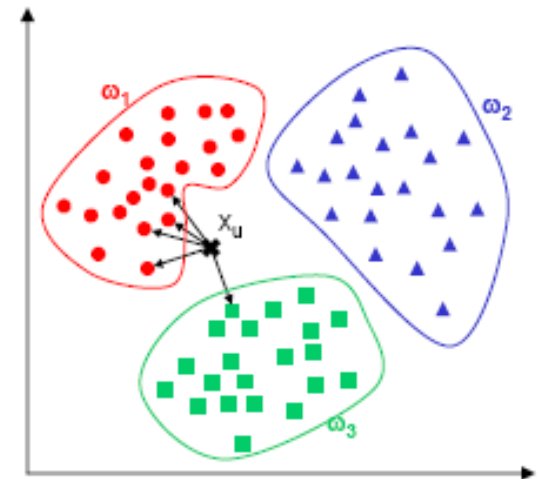
# Classification: $k$ Nearest Neighbor

- Example

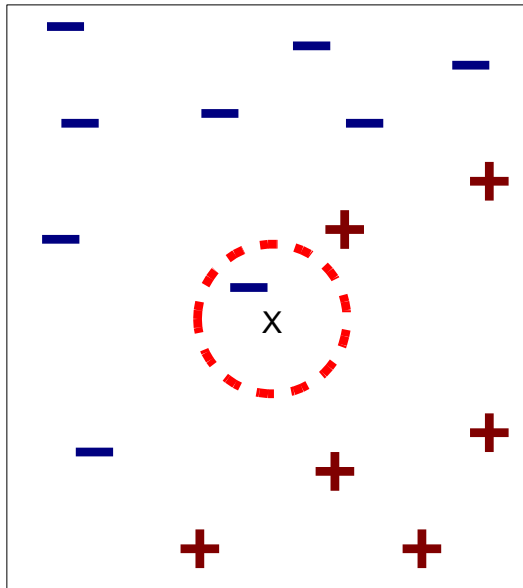
1) In the example below we have three classes and the goal is to find a class label for the unknown example  $x_u$

2) In this case we use the Euclidean distance and a value of  $k=5$  neighbors

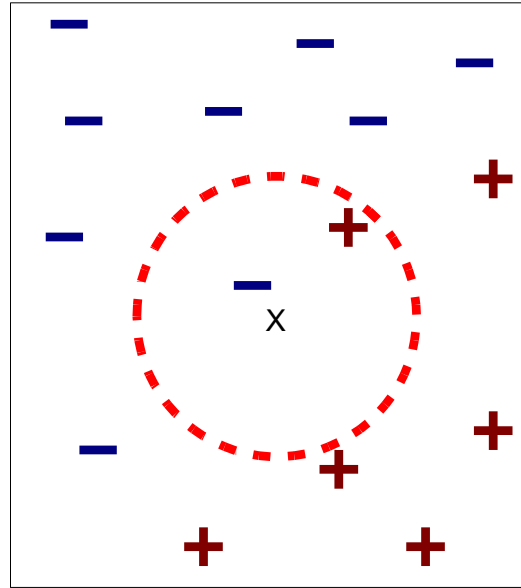
3) Of the 5 closest neighbors, 4 belong to  $w_1$  and 1 belongs to  $w_3$ , so  $x_u$  is assigned to  $w_1$ , the predominant class.



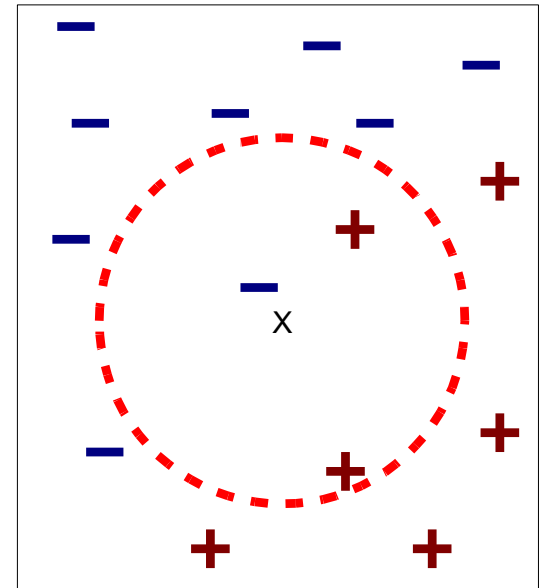
# Definition of Nearest Neighbor



(a) 1-nearest neighbor



(b) 2-nearest neighbor

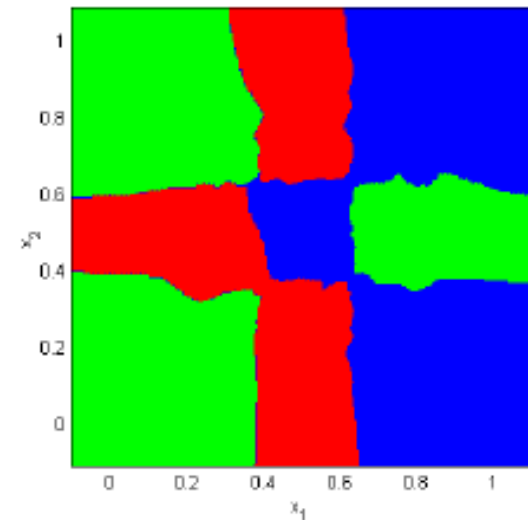
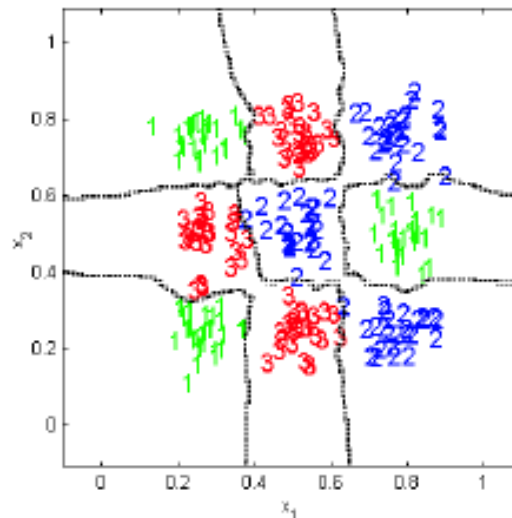
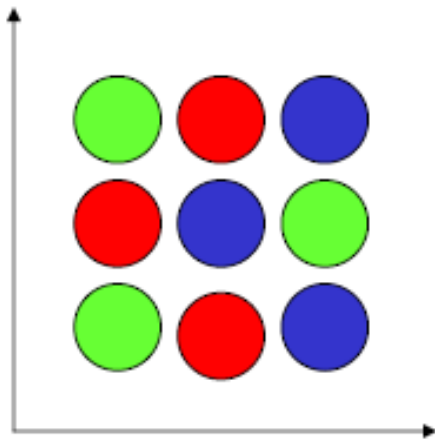


(c) 3-nearest neighbor

$K$ -nearest neighbors of a record  $x$  are data points that have the  $k$  smallest distance to  $x$

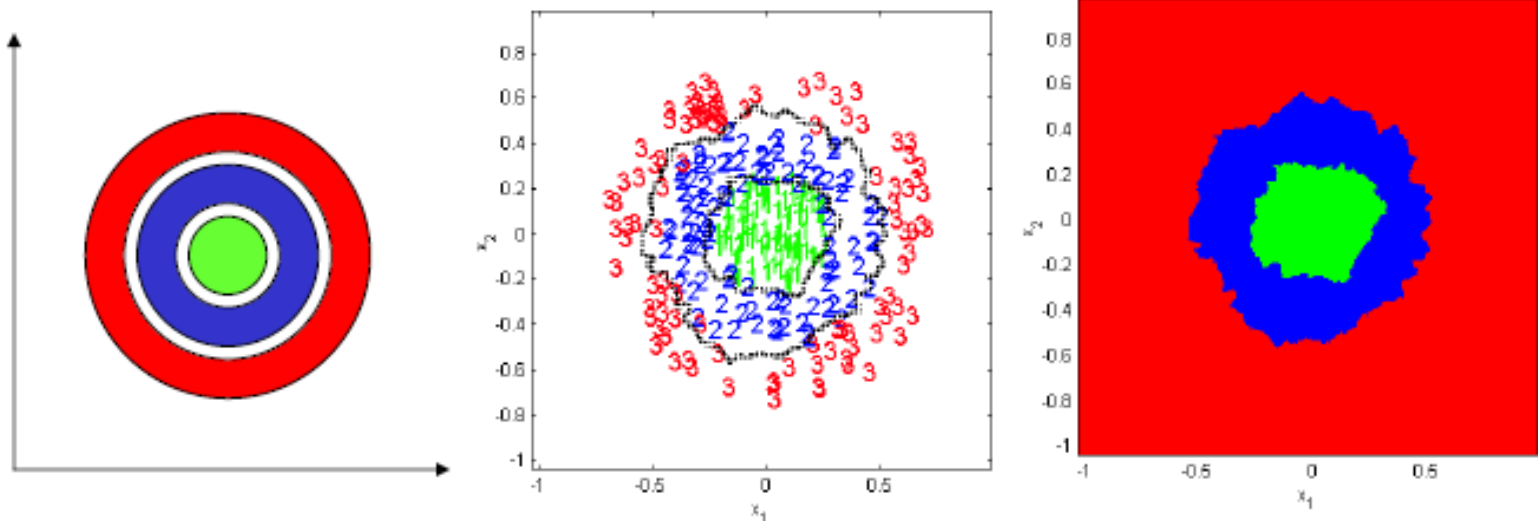
# kNN : Example 1

- We have generated data for a 2-dimensional 3-class problem, where the class-conditional densities are multi-modal, and non-linearly separable, as illustrated in the figure
- We used the  $k$ NN rule with
  - 1)  $k = 5$ ; 2) The Euclidean distance as a metric
- The resulting decision boundaries and decision regions are shown below



# $k$ NN: Example 2

- We have generated data for a 2-dimensional 3-class problem, where the class-conditional densities are unimodal, and are distributed in rings around a common mean. These classes are also non-linearly separable, as illustrated in the figure
- We used the  $k$ NN rule with
  - 1)  $k = 5$ ; 2) The Euclidean distance as a metric
- The resulting decision boundaries and decision regions are shown below



# $k$ NN: A Lazy Algorithm

- $k$ NN is considered a lazy learning algorithm
  - 1) Defers data processing until it receives a request to classify an unlabelled example
  - 2) Replies to a request for information by combining its stored training data
  - 3) Discards the constructed answer and any intermediate results
- This strategy is opposed to an eager learning algorithm which
  - 1) Compiles its data into a compressed description or model
    - A density estimate or density parameters or a graph structure and associated weights
  - 2) Discards the training data after compilation of the model
  - 3) Classifies incoming patterns using the induced model, which is retained for future requests

## Tradeoffs

- 1) Lazy algorithms have fewer computational costs than eager algorithms during Training
- 2) Lazy algorithms have greater storage requirements and higher computational costs on recall

# Characteristics of the $k$ NN classifier

- Advantages

- 1) Analytically tractable
- 2) Simple implementation
- 3) Nearly optimal in the large sample limit ( $N \rightarrow \infty$ )
- 4) Uses local information, which can yield highly adaptive behavior
- 5) Lends itself very easily to parallel implementations

- Disadvantages

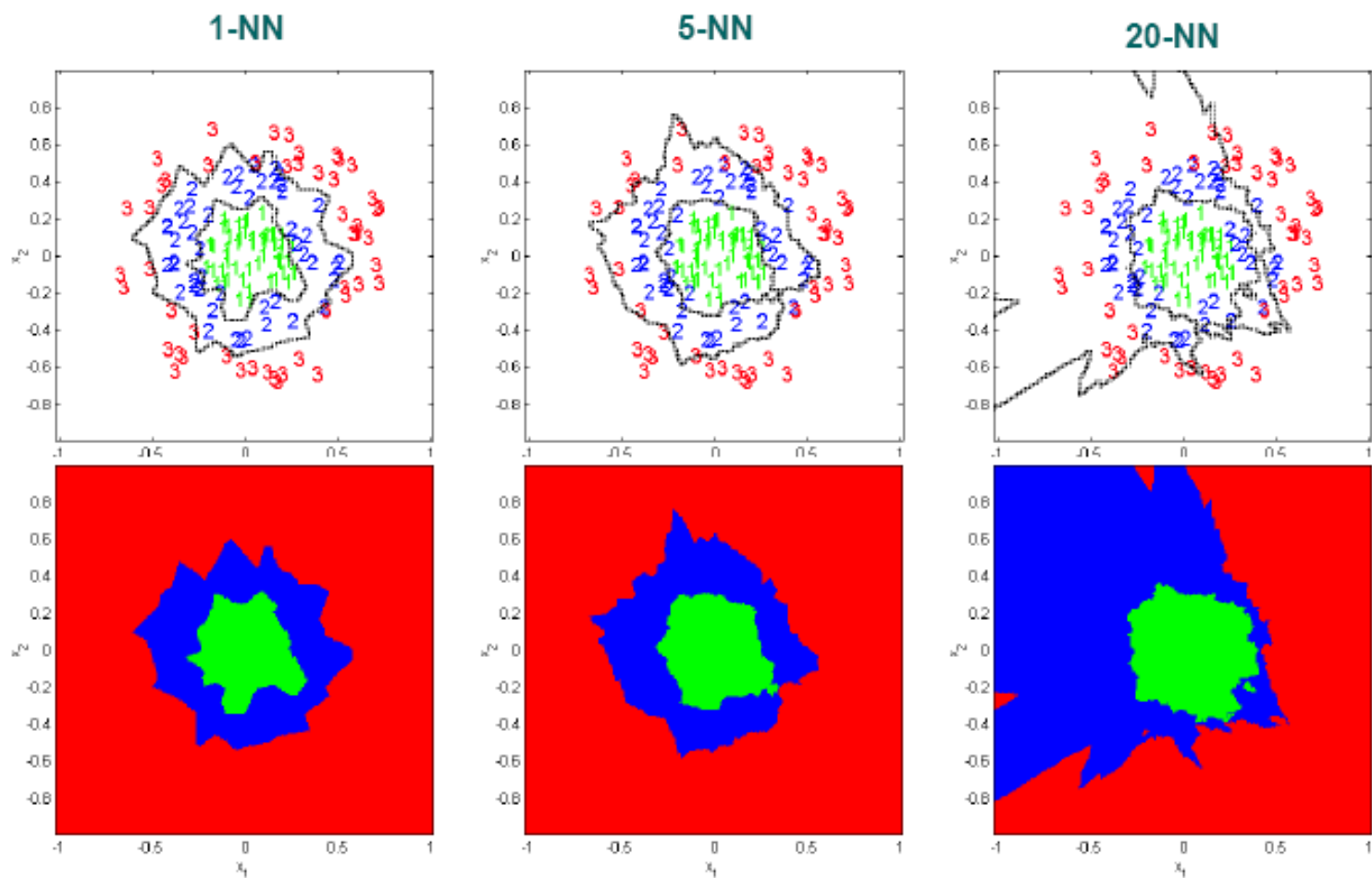
- 1) Large storage requirements
- 2) Computationally intensive recall
- 3) Highly susceptible to the curse of dimensionality



# $k$ NN versus 1NN

- The use of large values of  $k$  has two main advantages
  - a) Yields smoother decision regions
  - b) Provides probabilistic information (The ratio of examples for each class gives information about the ambiguity of the decision)
- However, too large a value of  $k$  is detrimental
  - a) It destroys the locality of the estimation since farther examples are taken into account
  - b) In addition, it increases the computational burden

# $k$ NN versus 1NN



# Optimizing storage requirements

- The basic  $k$ NN algorithm stores all the examples in the training set, creating high storage requirements (and computational cost)
  - 1) However, the entire training set need not be stored since the examples may contain information that is highly redundant
  - 2) In addition, almost all of the information that is relevant for classification purposes is located around the decision boundaries
- A number of methods, called edited  $k$ NN, have been derived to take advantage of this information redundancy
- A different alternative is to reduce the training examples to a set of prototypes that are representative of the underlying data

*clustering*

# Summary

- Face recognition: applications, challenges and systems
- $k$  Nearest Neighbor classifier for face recognition

**Thank you!**